

music

Rare Fusion

An Indian classical maestro joining chords with a ghazal singer is a rarity. So when sarod maestro Ustad Amjad Ali Khan and ghazal singer Pankaj Udhas joined forces last week to release *Yaara*, it was a moment for celebration. The album, brought out by Music Today, is a unique collection of seven love songs presented in a contemporary style.

Indian classical musicians like Ravi Shankar and the Shiv-Hari duo of Shiv Kumar Sharma and Hari Prasad Chaurasia have long been composing for films but a collaborative private album like this has come after a long time. Years ago, Khan made his foray into this form of vocals when he made some compositions for a 13-episode television serial *Guftagoo* on Doordarshan. He had also released an album, *Vaada*, with Gulzar. "As a classical musician, I feel inspired to compose. In a pure classi-

cal rendition, one cannot take liberties with the ragas but as a composer, you can weave and paint a beautiful portrait," says Khan, who actually carries a recorder with him while travelling to capture melodies inspired by nature or beauty.

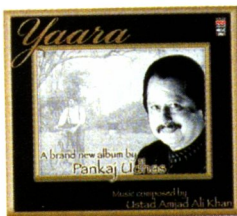
For Udhas, it was a dream come true to sing for Khan. Even as a child, he nurtured a great desire to meet Khan and *Yaara* helped fulfil his dream.

"Khan saheb would explain each ghazal to me before the recording and would insist that I sing with emotion. I admire his

simplicity and encouragement," says Udhas.

The music video for the title track, shot by Shiraz Bhattacharya, reflects the pangs of separation as a lover seeks his beloved. Udhas says that videos are a good promotional aid to reach out to the masses. The lyrics of the album have been penned by Sufi scholar Madan Mohan Gopal Singh and the music has been arranged by Hitesh Sonik of *Omkara* fame.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit



CORE DUO: Khan and Udhas team up for *Yaara*



music festival

Rhythm Corner

PANJIM Goa has produced some legendary Indian classical musicians such as the Mangeshkar family, Kishori Amonkar and Jitendra Abhisheki. Abhisheki came from a family of priests attached to the famous Mangeshi Temple in Goa. His style was an eclectic amalgamation of the Jaipur and Agra gharanas. He revived the Marathi music operas when it was dying. In his memory, his disciples along with his son Shounak Abhisheki, organise Pandit Jitendra Abhisheki Sangeet Mahotsav every year. This year the festival will be held at Dinanath Mangeshkar Auditorium on October 13 and 14. The artistes include Sanjeev Chimalgi, Madhup Mudgal, Uday Bhavalkar, Shashank Makdedar, Raja Kale, Balkrishna Kelkar, Malini Rajurkar (vocal); instrumentalists Bhawani Shankar (pakhawaj), Rakesh Chaurasia (flute) and Biswajit Roy Choudhary (sarod). Soak in some divine music from 9 a.m. till midnight.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

ODE TO A MAESTRO:
Rajurkar



theatre

Urban Blip

BANGALORE The premier of young playwright Ram Ganesh Kamath's latest play *Creeper* will be held in the city next week. The play centres around two individuals in urban Bangalore and shows their lives in a whirlpool of activities. There is everything from *Vikram Betal*, pornography, literary theory,



Poster of play orkut.com, Chanda-mama comics, blogging, Silk Smitha to foul language, Kurt Cobain, a narrator and a sutradhar who don't agree on anything. *Creeper* contains explicit language and is not for children. On October 13-14 at Ranga Shankara.

by Nirmala Ravindran